

## Press Statement

### End of the Temporary Permanent Status (TPS) for 9,000 Nepalis in USA

The Government of Nepal (GoN) housing recovery programme is an owner-driven reconstruction programme where the GoN are providing a housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs to 767,709 eligible households (as of 29 April 2018). The reconstruction grant is disbursed in three tranches linked to compliant construction; 50,000 NPRs upon signing the programme partnership agreement with the GoN, 150,000 NPRs after completing the foundation, and 100,000 NPRs after completing the walls (the certificate of completion is provided after completion of the roof and fittings). A retrofitting grant of 100,000 NPRs is also available to 24,986 eligible households (as of 29 April 2018) whose homes have been partially damaged. The National Reconstruction Authority and the Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Programme (HRRP) have defined a core package of socio-technical assistance activities to complement the GoN financial assistance. As of 24 April 2018, the NRA reports that 18.5% of households have completed the reconstruction of their home, and 57% of households have started construction of their home. It is expected that many of those that have yet to start, or are struggling to complete their homes are the most vulnerable and / or marginalised groups in society. Reconstruction actors are currently working together to plan for additional support for these households to make sure that no one is left behind in the housing recovery process.

The 9,000 Nepalis whose Temporary Protected Status has been removed are not refugees but are mainly wealthy Nepalis that were in the USA when the 2015 earthquake happened and applied to stay there under the TPS process. It is standard procedure for the TPS to be reassessed after a period of time after a disaster and the same process has been applied for several similar disasters, such as the Haiti earthquake in 2010. The returning Nepalis will have 1 year to return, so it is expected that they will return gradually during this period. They will likely have been earning in the USA during the last three years so may be returning with savings. It is expected that the return of these people will have limited impact on the reconstruction, and the impact of the reconstruction on them is expected to be limited. There may be opportunities for these people and families to contribute to the reconstruction.

*The Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) was established in December 2015 to support the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) and Ministry of Federal Affairs and Local Development (MoFALD) Central Level Programme Implementation Units (CL-PIUs), other relevant government authorities, and Partner Organisations (POs) with coordination of the post-earthquake housing reconstruction. The HRRP is led by CRS Nepal, and primarily funded by DFID and CRS. Other financial contributors and implementing partners include NSET, Oxfam, Caritas Nepal, Plan International, and Habitat for Humanity. The third phase of HRRP began in March 2017 and will run until the end of February 2019.*